

CENTRAL BOARD OF SECONDARY EDUCATION — PRACTICE EXAMINATION**CLASS IX • SOCIAL SCIENCE (SUBJECT CODE: 087) • ACADEMIC SESSION 2026-27****SET B — ADVANCED HOTS & ANALYTICAL THINKING****CHAPTER 07: ELECTIONS****TIME ALLOWED: 45 MINUTES****MAXIMUM MARKS: 25 MARKS****SERIES: CBS-IX-SST-SET-B-07****Student's Name:** _____**Roll No.:** _____**Class & Section:** Class IX - _____**Date of Exam:** _____**Invigilator's Sign:** _____**General Instructions (SET B - Advanced HOTS & Analytical Thinking):**

1. The question paper comprises **25 Higher Order Thinking Skills (HOTS) Questions** of **1 mark each**.
2. Designed to test **deep causal reasoning, critical source evaluation, constitutional mechanics, and economic analysis**.
3. All questions are compulsory. There is no negative marking for incorrect answers.
4. Darken the corresponding bubble on the **OMR Sheet** completely using a blue/black ballpoint pen.

 **ADVANCED HOTS INSTRUCTIONS:** Carefully analyze the socio-historical contexts, geomorphic cause-and-effect relationships, and constitutional principles before selecting your answer.

Q.1 In India's 'First-Past-The-Post' (FPTP) electoral system for Lok Sabha elections, how is the winning candidate in a single-member constituency determined?

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| (A) The candidate who secures the highest number of valid votes among all contestants wins, even if that is less than 50% of the total votes cast | (B) The candidate must secure an absolute majority of at least 50% plus one vote |
| (C) The winner is chosen by drawing lottery tickets from an earthen urn | (D) The candidate with the fewest votes is declared the winner by the President |

Q.2 What major distortion can occur between national 'vote share' and 'seat share' in an FPTP electoral system?

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| (A) A political party can win an overwhelming majority of parliamentary seats (e.g., 60%) despite securing only a modest share of the popular vote (e.g., 35–40%) | (B) A party with 100% of the popular vote is legally barred from taking office |
| (C) Every party receives exactly the same number of seats regardless of votes | (D) Seat share always equals vote share down to five decimal places |

Q.3 Why does the Indian Constitution provide for 'Reserved Constituencies' (SC and ST) rather than 'Separate Electorates' as was practiced during British colonial rule?

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| (A) Separate electorates deepened communal and caste segregation; reserved constituencies ensure social justice while requiring the candidate to seek votes from all community members equally | (B) Reserved constituencies permit only kings to vote in parliamentary elections |
| (C) Separate electorates are technically impossible with modern computers | (D) The British colonial government never introduced separate electorates |

Q.4 What is the constitutional process of 'Delimitation' conducted by the Delimitation Commission of India?

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| (A) Redrawing territorial boundaries of parliamentary and assembly constituencies based on updated census data to ensure each elected representative represents roughly an equal population | (B) Assigning government cars and houses to newly appointed ministers |
| (C) Printing ballot papers in secret underground currency presses | (D) Calculating the national income and gross domestic product |
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Q.5 Why is the Delimitation Commission's final order legally protected from being challenged in any court of law under Article 329 of the Constitution?

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| (A) To prevent unending litigation and court stays from indefinitely stalling the constitutional timetable for holding general elections | (B) Because the Delimitation Commission is an agency of the United Nations |
| (C) Because judges are not allowed to read maps or census tables | (D) Because constituency boundaries never change in Indian history |
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Q.6 How does the Election Commission of India (ECI) maintain constitutional autonomy from the ruling executive government?

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| (A) The Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) enjoys security of tenure like a Supreme Court judge and cannot be removed except by parliamentary impeachment with a two-thirds majority | (B) The CEC is an active cabinet minister in the ruling political party |
| (C) The ECI is funded directly by foreign commercial banks | (D) The ECI takes daily administrative operational orders from the Home Ministry |
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Q.7 When the Model Code of Conduct (MCC) takes effect upon the announcement of an election schedule, which of the following executive actions is strictly BANNED?

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| (A) Announcing major discretionary financial grants, laying foundation stones for welfare projects, or utilizing official state aircraft for campaign rallies | (B) Conducting police patrols to maintain neighborhood public safety |
| (C) Government doctors treating sick patients in public hospitals | (D) Paying monthly salaries to state civil servants |
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Q.8 Under landmark Supreme Court directives (*Association for Democratic Reforms*, 2002), what sworn declarations must candidates file in their nomination affidavits?

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| (A) Full disclosure of pending criminal charges, movable and immovable assets and liabilities (including spouse and dependents), and verified educational qualifications | (B) Their personal blood type, horoscope charts, and shoe size |
| (C) A legal promise to never resign from political party membership | (D) A declaration of ownership of space satellite rockets |
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Q.9 How does the Voter Verifiable Paper Audit Trail (VVPAT) system attached to an Electronic Voting Machine (EVM) enhance electoral integrity?

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| (A) It generates a physical printed paper slip visible behind glass for 7 seconds showing candidate name and symbol, creating a verifiable audit trail for random physical tally recounts | (B) It takes a digital facial photograph of the voter and posts it online |
| (C) It dispenses paper currency notes to citizens who vote for the ruling party | (D) It sends an automatic text message to foreign intelligence agencies |
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Q.10 What legal sanction does the Representation of the People Act, 1951 impose for practicing 'corrupt practices' such as bribing or intimidating voters or appealing to religion/caste?

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| (A) The election of the candidate can be declared null and void by the High Court, and the candidate can be disqualified from contesting for up to six years | (B) A small verbal apology is whispered to the returning officer |
| (C) The candidate is given an immediate promotion to cabinet minister | (D) There are zero legal consequences for corrupt practices in elections |

Q.11 Why does India experience a distinctive 'participatory upsurge' where marginalized, rural, and lower-income citizens vote in higher percentages than wealthy urban elites?

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| (A) Marginalized communities view the ballot as a vital tool of self-respect, collective dignity, and survival to pressure governments for public welfare goods and social protection | (B) Poor citizens are legally forced by police to vote under penalty of arrest |
| (C) Wealthy urban citizens are legally prohibited from entering polling stations | (D) Rural citizens receive free luxury cars at every polling booth |

Q.12 What is the function of the 'None of the Above' (NOTA) button on an Indian Electronic Voting Machine?

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| (A) It allows voters to exercise their democratic right to reject all contesting candidates in the constituency without violating ballot secrecy | (B) It automatically votes for the incumbent ruling party candidate |
| (C) It cancels the entire general election across all 543 constituencies | (D) It transfers the citizen's vote to the United Nations assembly |

Q.13 What is the primary rationale behind capping election campaign expenditure limits for candidates in parliamentary and assembly elections?

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| (A) To prevent the capture of democratic elections by wealthy plutocrats and ensure a relatively fair playing field for candidates of modest financial means | (B) To force candidates to give all their personal wealth to the state |
| (C) To prevent candidates from printing paper manifestos | (D) To ensure that elections take five years to complete |

Q.14 During the actual conduct of elections, who holds disciplinary and administrative authority over state civil servants, district magistrates, and police officers?

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| (A) The Election Commission of India exercises superintendence on deemed deputation, overriding state government ministers | (B) The Chief Minister of the State has total personal control |
| (C) Local municipal councilors give orders to the police chiefs | (D) Private corporate security guards manage all civil servants |

Q.15 What is 'booth capturing', and how did the introduction of Electronic Voting Machines (EVMs) systematically curb this practice?

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| (A) Criminal gangs seizing polling booths to stuff paper ballot boxes was curbed because EVMs record at a maximum speed of 5 votes per minute and feature instant 'Close' buttons | (B) Booth capturing was an art festival where people painted polling booths |
| (C) EVMs explode into fire if touched by unauthorized individuals | (D) EVMs only work when connected to the internet |

Q.16 What is the primary role of the 'General Observer' and 'Expenditure Observer' appointed by the Election Commission during an election?

- (A) Senior civil servants from other states act as the eyes and ears of the Commission to monitor fair play, prevent money/liquor distribution, and resolve citizen complaints
- (B) They count money to give to political campaign leaders
- (C) They deliver political speeches supporting the ruling party
- (D) They arrest ordinary citizens who refuse to vote

Q.17 Why is the practice of 'paid news' (disguising promotional political propaganda as independent journalistic reporting) considered a grave threat to free elections?

- (A) It deceives voters into mistaking paid campaign advertisements for objective news coverage, evades campaign spending limits, and corrupts media neutrality
- (B) It provides free newspapers to rural citizens who cannot afford them
- (C) It is completely legal and encouraged by all election guidelines
- (D) It causes printing presses to run out of black ink

Q.18 What constitutional protection does the 'Secret Ballot' ensure for every citizen in a democracy?

- (A) It guarantees that no person, employer, or government authority can find out how an individual citizen voted, shielding voters from coercion, intimidation, or retribution
- (B) It requires all voters to keep their names secret from family members
- (C) It allows the police to see which candidate every voter selected
- (D) It requires voting to take place in pitch-black darkness without lights

Q.19 How does the 'cVIGIL' mobile application launched by the Election Commission empower ordinary Indian citizens to enforce election integrity?

- (A) Citizens can capture photos or videos of Model Code of Conduct violations (like bribery, hate speech, or freebie distribution) with automatic geotagging for rapid flying squad action
- (B) It allows citizens to vote directly from their home mobile phones
- (C) It automatically predicts who will win the national election
- (D) It arrests politicians automatically through computer algorithms

Q.20 Why is the continuous summary revision of the Electoral Roll (Voters' List) conducted annually by the Election Commission?

- (A) To register newly eligible 18-year-old citizens, update shifted residences, and remove the names of deceased individuals to keep voter lists accurate
- (B) To eliminate all citizens who did not vote in the previous election
- (C) To reduce the number of voters to zero in every city
- (D) To change citizens' names to ancient historical titles

Q.21 What is the legal purpose of applying indelible ink (containing silver nitrate) to a voter's left index finger at the polling booth?

- (A) Silver nitrate reacts with skin proteins to form an insoluble black silver chloride stain that cannot be washed off, preventing fraudulent duplicate voting
- (B) It serves as a temporary medical vaccine against tropical flu
- (C) It is a decorative cosmetic tattoo applied for celebration
- (D) It gives the voter special access to free government transport

Q.22 How does dynasty politics (family control over party candidacies) undermine the democratic quality of Indian elections?

- (A) It restricts political upward mobility for talented, ordinary grassroots party workers and concentrates power within hereditary family oligarchies
- (B) It guarantees that only highly educated candidates contest elections
- (C) It is required by the Indian Constitution under Article 370
- (D) It makes elections completely free of any financial expenditure

Q.23 What is a 'mid-term election' versus a 'by-election' in Indian parliamentary democracy?

- (A) A mid-term election is held for the entire Lok Sabha or Vidhan Sabha when dissolved before its full 5-year term; a by-election is held for a single vacant seat due to death or resignation
- (B) A mid-term election is held every weekend; a by-election is held every century
- (C) A by-election elects the President; a mid-term election elects the Chief Justice
- (D) Both terms refer to identical school classroom examinations

Q.24 Why does the Law Commission of India advocate for state funding of elections or stringent transparency in political party contributions?

- (A) To curb the illicit influx of unaccounted black money and corporate kickbacks that corrupt democratic policy and buy legislative influence
- (B) To force all political parties to close their offices permanently
- (C) To make all election campaigns completely free of speeches
- (D) To allow foreign corporations to directly purchase parliamentary seats

Q.25 What democratic purpose is served by the 'silence period' (the ban on public campaigning 48 hours prior to the close of voting)?

- (A) To provide voters with a quiet period free from high-decibel propaganda, hate speech, and rallies to reflect calmly on candidate choices
- (B) To allow candidates to sleep for 48 hours without eating
- (C) To allow the police to arrest all campaign managers
- (D) To prevent the sun from setting on polling day

CBSE CANDIDATE OMR ANSWER RESPONSE GRID (SET B)

01 (A) (B) (C) (D)	02 (A) (B) (C) (D)	03 (A) (B) (C) (D)	04 (A) (B) (C) (D)	05 (A) (B) (C) (D)
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11 (A) (B) (C) (D)	12 (A) (B) (C) (D)	13 (A) (B) (C) (D)	14 (A) (B) (C) (D)	15 (A) (B) (C) (D)
16 (A) (B) (C) (D)	17 (A) (B) (C) (D)	18 (A) (B) (C) (D)	19 (A) (B) (C) (D)	20 (A) (B) (C) (D)
21 (A) (B) (C) (D)	22 (A) (B) (C) (D)	23 (A) (B) (C) (D)	24 (A) (B) (C) (D)	25 (A) (B) (C) (D)

Total Questions Attempted: ____ / 25

Marks Obtained: ____ / 25

Evaluator's Signature: _____

OFFICIAL ANSWER KEY & STEP-BY-STEP EXPLANATIONS (SET B)

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Reference & Analytical Rationale
Q.1	(A)	Under the FPTP system, plurality wins: the candidate with more votes than any single rival is elected, frequently winning with 30–40% in multi-cornered contests.
Q.2	(A)	FPTP exaggerates seat share for the leading party across divided constituencies, meaning popular vote percentages rarely match legislative seat proportions.
Q.3	(A)	Dr. Ambedkar and Mahatma Gandhi's Poona Pact (1932) established joint electorates with reserved seats: only SC/ST candidates contest, but all citizens in the constituency vote.
Q.4	(A)	The independent Delimitation Commission redraws constituency boundaries after decennial censuses to preserve the 'one vote, one value' population parity principle.
Q.5	(A)	Article 329 bars judicial interference in delimitation orders to prevent legal petitions from freezing or paralyzing scheduled election cycles.
Q.6	(A)	Article 324 guarantees institutional insulation: the CEC cannot be removed by executive whim and their conditions of service cannot be altered to their disadvantage.
Q.7	(A)	The MCC prevents ruling incumbents from using state exchequer resources, official vehicles, or last-minute project launches to unfairly bias voters.
Q.8	(A)	Voters' Right to Information mandates sworn affidavits disclosing criminal records, wealth, liabilities, and education so voters can make informed, enlightened choices.
Q.9	(A)	VVPAT provides physical verification: voters see their ballot printed on paper before it drops into a sealed box, allowing manual verification of electronic tallies.
Q.10	(A)	Section 123 of the RPA criminalizes bribery, caste appeals, and booth capturing; High Courts can set aside election results and disqualify violators.
Q.11	(A)	In Indian democracy, voting empowers marginalized groups to exert political leverage, demand welfare benefits, and challenge entrenched social hierarchies.
Q.12	(A)	Introduced following the Supreme Court's *PUCL* ruling (2013), NOTA provides a confidential option to register disapproval of all candidates.
Q.13	(A)	Statutory expenditure ceilings curb black money and exorbitant spending, preventing wealthy elites from monopolizing electoral visibility.
Q.14	(A)	Officers on election duty are on deemed deputation to the ECI under Article 324; the Commission can transfer, suspend, or reprimand officials who exhibit bias.
Q.15	(A)	EVMs enforce a 5-vote-per-minute rate limiter, preventing instant ballot stuffing; presiding officers can press the 'Close' button to freeze balloting instantly during attacks.
Q.16	(A)	Independent Central Observers (IAS/IRS officers deployed outside their home cadres) oversee operations, shadow candidate expenditure, and ensure free and fair administration.
Q.17	(A)	Paid news is deceptive corrupt expenditure: it launders partisan campaign propaganda as neutral journalism, misleading voters and evading statutory spending ceilings.
Q.18	(A)	Secret balloting protects individual conscience: voters can vote against powerful landlords, employers, or party bosses without fear of retaliation.
Q.19	(A)	cVIGIL crowdsources electoral vigilance: citizens upload geo-tagged photos/videos of MCC violations, triggering field flying squads within 100 minutes.

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Reference & Analytical Rationale
Q.20	(A)	Annual summary revisions update the electoral roll, ensuring young adults enroll at 18 while removing deceased or permanently migrated electors to prevent impersonation.
Q.21	(A)	Manufactured by Mysore Paints, silver nitrate ink bonds with skin keratin and darkens on exposure to light, preventing multiple voting across booths.
Q.22	(A)	Dynastic succession concentrates ticket distribution within family networks, shutting out qualified grassroots leaders and reducing democratic accountability.
Q.23	(A)	A mid-term election renews the entire legislative chamber following premature dissolution; a by-election fills an isolated constituency vacancy.
Q.24	(A)	Transparent party financing and limited public funding decouple electoral politics from covert corporate quid-pro-quo financing.
Q.25	(A)	Section 126 of the RPA imposes a 48-hour campaign blackout, offering electors calm reflection away from shrill rallies, disinformation, and canvassing.